

PublicBrief

See what is being proposed and how it affects you.

A source-grounded, resident-centered tool for turning public documents into civic decision workflows at grassroots levels.

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PROBLEM

Local gov’t decisions are made publicly, but the process can appear opaque.

LOCAL CONTEXT

Why this matters to me

- Member of Loudoun County’s Community Services Board.
- Independent research on the effect of data centers, APLRs (e.g. Flock), public-private contracts on local communities.
- Constituent quality of life largely depends on local, municipal governance.

INFORMATION GAP

Residents lack awareness

Agenda packets, staff reports, and procurement items are technically public, but hard to interpret quickly.

POWER GAP

Institutions track early

Vendors, developers, and organized stakeholders often have the capacity to monitor decisions before a vote using tools like Hamlet.

MOBILITY GAP

Public scrutiny arrives late

When residents are not actively tracking, consequential proposals can advance before questioned publicly.

PublicBrief seeks to solve the issue of policy translation by creating a decision workflow.

SOLUTION

PublicBrief moves beyond summarization towards a decision workflow for residents.

PublicBrief DMV connects document comprehension, decision accountability, source evidence, and resident participation in one flow.



PublicBrief increases accessibility of local government to encourage constituent participation.

RESPONSIBLE AI

Designed to help users verify and analyze facts rather than creating blind trust.

Because this tool deals with public decisions, the prototype is intentionally cautious about facts, contacts, and action.

01	Source text is evidence, not instructions	Pasted content is treated as untrusted source material to reduce prompt-injection risk.
02	Missing information stays visible	Dates, officials, procedures, and contacts are not invented when they are not in the source.
03	Facts are separated from implications	The brief distinguishes what is documented from cautious civic implications.
04	Controlled technical surface	Server-side AI calls, structured output, request validation, and no arbitrary HTML rendering.
05	Resident stays in control	No automatic emails, no generated contact links, and repeated reminders to verify official sources.

DEMO PATH

Using the one county prototype to prompt broader civic monitoring.

The prototype demonstrates both the future monitoring experience and the working document-analysis core that would drive PublicBrief extensions.

